Stock Photo Downloader - User Manual

Overview

`download_stock_photos.py` downloads JPEG photos from Lorem Picsum, a free service that serves Unsplash-sourced stock images. No API key is required. The script uses only the Python standard library.

Requirements

- Python 3.10 or newer
- Internet connection

Quick start

From the folder that contains the script:

```
python download_stock_photos.py
```

This downloads **10** random JPEGs (1280x720) into a `photos` folder.

Show all options:

```
python download_stock_photos.py --help
```

Common examples

Download 10 photos into `photos`:

```
python download_stock_photos.py -n 10 -o photos
```

Larger images:

```
python download_stock_photos.py --width 1920 --height 1080
```

Grayscale with a light blur:

```
python download_stock_photos.py --grayscale --blur 2
```

Same images every time (reproducible):

```
python download_stock_photos.py --seed demo
```

Force overwrite of existing files:

```
python download_stock_photos.py --overwrite
```

Command-line options

Option	Default	Description
`-n`, `--count`	`10`	Number of photos to download
`-o`, `--output`	`photos`	Output directory
`--width`	`1280`	Image width in pixels
`--height`	`720`	Image height in pixels
`--page`	*(random)*	Use one Picsum list page only (1-10)
`--seed`	*(none)*	Reproducible Picsum seed mode
`--grayscale`	off	Download grayscale images
`--blur 1-10`	off	Apply blur level 1-10
`--timeout`	`30`	HTTP timeout in seconds
`--delay`	`0.2`	Pause between downloads (seconds)
`--overwrite`	off	Replace existing files with the same name
`-q`, `--quiet`	off	Print errors only
`-h`, `--help`	-	Show help and exit

How image selection works

- **Default:** each run samples **random** images from the Picsum catalog, so calling the script twice usually yields different photos.

- **`--page N`:** take images from list page `N` only (still shuffled within that page's pool when sampling).
- **`--seed NAME`:** download a fixed, reproducible set based on Picsum seeds.

Files are named like `picsum_<id>_<author>.jpg`. If a file already exists and `--overwrite` is not set, that download is skipped.

Output

- Progress lines show each saved, skipped, or failed file.
- A summary line reports counts and the absolute output directory path.
- Exit code `0` means success (or only skips); a non-zero code indicates a hard failure or that nothing could be downloaded.

Notes

- Be polite to the service; the default `--delay` adds a short pause between requests.
- Image availability depends on Lorem Picsum; occasional network or empty-result errors can occur.
- Photos are for use under the terms of Lorem Picsum / the original Unsplash photographers' licenses.

License / attribution

Images come from Lorem Picsum (https://picsum.photos). Credit photographers when your use case requires it.